

FROM STRUGGLE TO STRENGTH

A STREET SMART GUIDE TO
BUILDING WEALTH



TERRANCE GEE

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From Struggle to Strength

A Street Smart Guide to Building Wealth

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1

Chapter 1 – Your Mind is the Money Maker

“Where you start doesn’t decide where you finish.”

If you grew up in an environment where bills are always late, money disappears as soon as it comes in, and “wealth” means having enough for name-brand sneakers... it’s easy to believe that’s just the way life is.

But here’s the truth: you are not stuck.

Your current bank balance is a snapshot of where you are — not who you are. The moment you understand that your mind creates your money reality, you unlock a new level of control over your life.

Money Is Created in the Mind First

Napoleon Hill said in *Think and Grow Rich*, “Whatever the mind can conceive and believe, it can achieve.” Sounds nice, right? But let’s break that down in real terms:

- Everything you see that makes money — a business, a product, a service — started as an idea in someone’s head.
- The reason many people stay broke isn’t because they’re not smart; it’s because they never let themselves dream past

survival.

Think about it: The richest man in the world and the guy working three part-time jobs both have 24 hours in a day. The difference? One is thinking about how to make money work for him, while the other is thinking about how to keep working for money.

Why Mindset Matters More When You're at a Disadvantage

If you've had to fight through poverty, bad neighborhoods, or a lack of opportunities, you might think you're already behind. But here's the hidden advantage:

- You already know how to survive on little — which means you'll know how to multiply a little into a lot.

- You've been forced to be resourceful — that same skill can be flipped into entrepreneurial creativity.

The difference between someone who escapes poverty and someone who stays in it often comes down to one thing: belief. If you don't believe you can be wealthy, your brain won't even bother looking for the ways to make it happen.

The Trash Man to Cash Man Truth

Myron Golden went from picking up garbage to running million-dollar businesses. He didn't win the lottery. He didn't have a rich uncle. What he had was a decision: "I'm not staying broke."

That decision forced him to start learning the rules of money. Once he knew the rules, the game changed. You can't win a game you don't know how to play — but once you learn, the game becomes yours to win.

Action Step: Start Your Money Vision

Tonight, take out a notebook (or even your phone notes) and write the answers to these three questions:

1. What does "wealth" mean to me?

2. What's one thing I want to do for myself or my family when I have more money?

3. What's one skill I already have that I could use to make money?

Don't overthink it. Just write. You're not making a business plan — you're planting seeds.

Remember: Your mind is the money maker. If you change the way you think about money, you change the way money comes to you.

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Chapter 2 – The Power of Faith + Persistence

“It’s not the size of the check you start with, it’s the size of the fight inside you.”

When you’ve grown up watching money slip through your fingers the second you get it, it’s easy to feel like wealth is for “other people.” That’s where faith comes in — not just spiritual faith (though that’s powerful too), but the belief that your life can be bigger than your current situation.

Without faith, you won’t even try. Without persistence, you won’t finish.

You need both.

Breaking the “Mental Ceiling”

A “mental ceiling” is the invisible limit you put on yourself. Maybe you grew up thinking making \$40k a year was a good life. Or maybe you believe owning a home is only for people with “good jobs.”

That’s your ceiling talking.

Faith is saying, “What if I could do more than that?”

Persistence is saying, “I’m going to keep going until I get

there, no matter how long it takes.”

The Rich Dad way of thinking flips this on its head: instead of asking, “Can I afford this?” start asking, “How can I afford this?” That small shift forces your brain to find possibilities instead of excuses.

Why Faith Without Work is Dead

Faith isn’t about sitting around hoping the money shows up. Faith means believing the effort will be worth it, before you see the reward.

Here’s the thing:

- People quit too early because they don’t see results fast enough.
- The wealth game is a “plant now, harvest later” game.

In *The Richest Man in Babylon*, the richest guy didn’t get rich in a week — he got rich by planting seeds of gold (money) and letting them grow over years. That’s exactly what persistence looks like.

How to Build Persistence Muscle

You build persistence the same way you build physical muscle — by pushing through resistance.

1. Set a small, realistic goal. Example: Save \$10 a week, no matter what.
2. Keep that promise to yourself. Even if you’re tired. Even if things are tight.
3. Stack wins. Once you’ve done it for a month, double the goal.

Each time you follow through, your persistence muscle gets stronger. Before you know it, you’ll have the mental strength to stick to big goals — like starting a business or buying property.

The Myron Golden Story You Need to Hear

When Myron Golden started out, people laughed at his dreams.

He had every excuse to stay broke — low-paying job, no big connections, no “fancy” degree. But he decided he’d rather get laughed at for dreaming too big than pitied for not trying at all.

That decision led him to study wealth, invest in himself, and show up every day — even on the days he didn’t feel like it. That’s persistence.

Action Step: Create a No-Quit Contract

Write down one money goal you want to hit in the next 90 days — it could be saving \$300, paying off a bill, or making an extra \$500 in side income.

- Sign your name under it.
- Put it somewhere you’ll see every day.
- Promise yourself: No excuses. No quitting.

Remember: Faith gets you started. Persistence gets you finished. And finishing is where the money lives.

3

Chapter 3 – The Real Definition of Wealth

“Being broke is temporary. Staying broke is a choice.”

Here’s a truth most people never learn:

You can look rich and be broke, or you can look average and be wealthy.

A guy in the club popping \$300 bottles might have \$12 in his bank account. The quiet woman driving a 10-year-old car might own three houses and have \$100k in investments.

The difference? One spends money to prove they have it. The other uses money to make more money.

Assets vs. Liabilities — The Street Version

Robert Kiyosaki in Rich Dad Poor Dad keeps it simple:

- Assets: Things that put money in your pocket.
- Liabilities: Things that take money out of your pocket.

Street example:

- That car with a \$700 monthly payment? Liability.
- That same car if you rent it out on Turo and it earns \$1,000 a month? Asset.

The rich focus on stacking assets. The poor focus on stacking

liabilities they think are assets.

Why Working Hard Isn't Enough

If working hard made you rich, construction workers and janitors would all be millionaires. The truth? Hard work is only step one.

Wealthy people:

1. Earn money.
2. Use some of it to buy assets.
3. Let those assets make more money.

Poor people:

1. Earn money.
2. Spend it all on bills, status items, and quick fun.
3. Start over broke next paycheck.

You can't just outwork poverty — you have to outthink it.

The Babylonian Secret

In The Richest Man in Babylon, wealth wasn't about earning the most — it was about keeping and multiplying what you earned. The richest man saved 10% of everything he made and invested it into things that would grow.

If you make \$100, save \$10 and make that \$10 work for you. It doesn't matter if you start small — what matters is that you start.

Real-World Shift You Can Make Today

- Stop thinking: "I can't afford to invest."
- Start thinking: "How can I make even \$5 this week work for me?"

When you treat money as a soldier you send out to fight for more money, you stop killing off your army by spending it all.

Action Step: The Money Flow Check

For the next week, write down every dollar that comes in and every dollar that goes out. At the end of the week, highlight in

green everything that puts money in your pocket (assets) and in red everything that takes it out (liabilities).

Your goal is simple:

- Add more green.
- Cut more red.

Remember: Wealth isn't about how much you make — it's about how much you keep and how well you make it grow.

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Chapter 4 – The 10-10-10 Rule for Money Flow

“If you can’t manage \$10, you can’t manage \$10,000.”

One of the biggest lies about building wealth is that you have to wait until you’re “making real money” before you start saving or investing. The truth?

If you can’t manage \$100, you won’t magically know how to manage \$100,000.

This is why most lottery winners go broke within five years — they never learned how to flow their money.

The 10-10-10 Rule

Here’s the system: Every time you get money — paycheck, side hustle, birthday gift, whatever — you split it like this:

- 10% for Building Wealth (Investing)
- 10% for Giving (Helping others / community)
- 10% for Education (Courses, books, skills)
- Live on the remaining 70%

Why This Works

1. Wealth Building — This is your seed money. It goes into things that make more money: investments, small businesses,

savings for a down payment, etc.

2. Giving — Sounds backwards, but giving changes how you think about money. It breaks the “scarcity” mindset and keeps you connected to purpose.

3. Education — Skills pay the bills. The richer you want to be, the more valuable skills you need.

4. Living on 70% — Forces you to live under your means so you have room to grow.

“But I don’t make enough to do that...”

That’s what everyone says — until they try. Even if all you can do right now is 1-1-1 instead of 10-10-10, start there. The habit matters more than the amount.

If you make \$50 this week:

- \$5 goes to wealth building.
- \$5 goes to giving.
- \$5 goes to education.
- You live on \$35.

Yes, it’ll feel tight at first — but remember, the goal isn’t comfort right now, it’s freedom later.

Where to Put Each 10%

• Wealth Building: High-yield savings account, investment app (Acorns, Robinhood, Fidelity), or real estate savings.

• Giving: Charity, helping a friend in need, buying supplies for someone’s small business.

• Education: Personal finance books, online courses, mentorship programs.

A Babylon Lesson in Action

In The Richest Man in Babylon, Arkad — the richest man — didn’t wait to be rich before he saved. He became rich because he saved first. That’s the secret.

Even Myron Golden says if you can’t manage small amounts,

God (and life) won't trust you with big ones.

Action Step: Open Three Money Jars (or Accounts)

- Label them "Wealth," "Giving," and "Education."
- Every time money comes in, drop your percentages in before you spend a single dollar.
- Watch what happens in 3 months — you'll have more saved than you thought possible.

Remember: The amount doesn't matter. The habit does. Get the flow right now, and you'll never be broke again.

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Chapter 5 – Escaping the Poverty Cycle

“Broke is a situation. Poverty is a mindset.”

You’ve seen it before — people get a little extra money and it’s gone in a week.

New shoes. New phone. Eating out every night. Then... back to “I’m broke” until the next check.

That’s the poverty cycle — and if you don’t break it, it will eat every dollar you make for the rest of your life.

The Cycle Looks Like This:

1. Get paid.
2. Spend on bills + “I deserve this” splurges.
3. Run out of money.
4. Wait for the next paycheck.
5. Repeat forever.

It’s comfortable because it’s familiar. But it’s dangerous because it keeps you one missed paycheck away from a crisis.

Why “Status Spending” Keeps You Broke

Poor neighborhoods are full of people wearing wealth instead of owning it.

- \$200 sneakers but no savings account.

- \$1,000 iPhone but behind on rent.
- Car worth more than the apartment's yearly rent.

Wealthy people don't need to prove they have money. They let their assets speak for them.

In Rich Dad Poor Dad, Kiyosaki warns against buying liabilities that look like assets. If you're buying something just to show off, it's usually a liability.

How to Break the Cycle

1. Kill impulse spending. Wait 48 hours before buying anything that isn't food, bills, or gas. Most of the time, you'll realize you don't even want it anymore.
2. Pay yourself first. That's the 10-10-10 Rule we covered — treat saving and investing like rent you must pay.
3. Upgrade your skills. The fastest way out of the cycle is to earn more without spending more.
4. Plan your money before you get it. Have a spending plan ready for every dollar before payday.

The Mind Flip That Changes Everything

Instead of asking:

- "What can I buy with this money?"

Ask:

- "How can I make this money make me more money?"

That single question can turn \$20 into \$40... \$100 into \$300... and eventually into enough to buy the freedom you want.

A Myron Golden Truth Bomb

Myron says the only way to escape poverty is to make decisions like a wealthy person before you become wealthy. That means living below your means, building assets, and saying no to things that give short-term pleasure but long-term pain.

Action Step: The "Flip It" Challenge

This week, take \$20 and figure out how to turn it into more

money. Sell something you don't use. Offer a quick service (yard work, cleaning, delivery). Then take the profit and repeat.

You'll prove to yourself that you control the money — it doesn't control you.

Remember: You can't escape the poverty cycle by working harder at the same bad money habits. You have to think, spend, and invest differently.

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Chapter 6 – How to Get Money When You Have None

“Money isn’t the problem. The problem is thinking you can’t make any.”

I get it — you might be reading this with \$0 in your account, overdue bills, and no idea where to start.

But here’s the truth: you don’t need money to start making money. You need creativity, hustle, and a willingness to start small.

In fact, some of the richest people you know started from nothing — they just found a way to get cash flowing first, and then used that flow to build wealth.

The 3 Stages of Money Building

1. Get it – Start a hustle that puts cash in your hand fast.
2. Grow it – Use part of that cash to buy or create something that makes more money.
3. Guard it – Protect it from bad spending and invest it into assets.

Most people fail because they skip stages — they get it, then blow it.

Quick Hustles You Can Start Today (No Money Needed)

- Service Hustles – Cutting grass, washing cars, moving furniture, babysitting, cleaning houses, grocery delivery. (All sweat, no startup cost.)
- Flipping – Sell things you already have but don't use. Then reinvest the profit into more items to flip. You can find free or cheap stuff on Facebook Marketplace, OfferUp, Craigslist "Free" section.
- Gig Work – DoorDash, Uber Eats, Instacart, TaskRabbit. If you have a phone and a bike/car, you can start in days.
- Digital Skills – Offer resume writing, logo design, or social media help to small businesses. (Learn free on YouTube if you don't know how yet.)

The "Skill Upgrade" Secret

Myron Golden calls this moving from low-income skills to high-income skills.

- Low-income skills: things that pay \$10–\$15/hr.
- High-income skills: things that can earn \$100–\$1,000 per client (sales, marketing, design, coding, copywriting, consulting).

The trick? Start with the low-income skill to get immediate money, and while you're working, invest time in learning a high-income skill so you can level up.

The Rich Dad Strategy

Kiyosaki says the wealthy focus on acquiring assets that pay them over and over. Once you get some money flowing, don't buy more liabilities — buy your first little asset.

That could be:

- A vending machine.
- A piece of equipment you rent out.
- A digital product you can sell repeatedly.

Action Step: Your “No-Excuse” Plan

1. Pick one hustle from the list above that you can start this week.
2. Set a 7-day goal (Example: Make \$100 in 7 days).
3. Use 50% of your profit to start your next hustle or buy an asset.

Remember: If you can make \$1 without a boss, you can make \$10. If you can make \$10, you can make \$100. The only limit is how often you repeat the process.

Chapter 7 – Make Your Money Multiply

“Don’t work for money forever. Make money work for you.”

If all your money comes from you trading hours for dollars, you’re stuck.

Why? Because there are only 24 hours in a day, and you can’t work all of them.

Wealthy people do something different — they send their money out like little workers, and those workers bring back more money. That’s called investing.

The Power of Compound Growth

Compound growth is when your money earns money, and then that money also starts earning money.

Example:

- You put \$100 in an investment that grows 10% a year.
- After year 1, you have \$110.
- After year 2, you don’t just grow on the \$100 — you grow on \$110. Now you have \$121.
- Over years, it snowballs into much more without you putting in extra hours.

Albert Einstein (yeah, the science genius) called compound

interest “the eighth wonder of the world.”

Places to Make Your Money Work

- Stock Market – You can buy shares of companies or index funds that grow over time. (Apps like Robinhood, Fidelity, M1 Finance make this easy.)

- Real Estate – Buying property to rent out or flip. Start small — even land or mobile homes can build wealth.

- Small Businesses – Start something that keeps paying you after the work is done, like vending machines, ATMs, or digital products.

The Babylon Way

In The Richest Man in Babylon, they call this “making your gold multiply.” The idea is simple: Don’t let money sit around doing nothing — it should always be somewhere earning more.

If your money is just in a checking account, it’s getting lazy. Put it somewhere it can work.

Start Small — Really Small

If you’ve only got \$5, you can invest it. Apps like Acorns let you start with your spare change. Don’t wait until you “have more” — start now so your money has more time to grow.

\$5 a week invested for 10 years at 10% growth is over \$4,000. That’s from just \$5 a week.

The Myron Golden Principle

Myron says, “Wealth is not built by big moves; it’s built by small moves, done consistently, over time.”

That means if you invest \$10 every week without fail, it’s better than investing \$500 once and quitting.

Action Step: Start Your First Money Worker

1. Pick an investment method you understand (stocks, savings, small business).
2. Put something in it this week — even \$1.

3. Make a rule: Never pull it out unless it's to buy another asset.

Remember: The goal is not just to have money — it's to have money that works harder than you do.

8

Chapter 8 – Build Credit Like a Boss

“Credit can be your ladder to wealth — or your chain to debt.”

Credit is like fire.

- Use it the right way, it can cook your food, heat your home, and keep you alive.

- Use it the wrong way, it will burn your whole house down.

Most people in disadvantaged situations only see the burn side because they’ve been taught to use credit for spending, not investing.

Why Credit Matters

- Loans & Mortgages: Good credit can help you buy property, start a business, or get low-interest loans.

- Lower Costs: Good credit gets you lower interest rates, which means you keep more of your money.

- Opportunities: Many landlords, employers, and service providers check your credit score.

In short, credit is your financial reputation. Protect it.

The Credit Game Plan

If you have no credit:

1. Open a secured credit card — You put in \$200–\$500 of your

own money as the limit.

2. Buy something small each month — Like gas or groceries.
3. Pay it off in full every month — Never carry a balance.

If you have bad credit:

1. Get a credit-builder loan from your local credit union.
2. Pay every bill on time — Payment history is 35% of your credit score.
3. Keep credit use low — Try not to use more than 30% of your available limit.

The Rich Dad Way to Use Credit

Robert Kiyosaki uses credit to buy assets — things that pay him back.

- Good credit → buys a rental property → rent covers the loan payment → property grows in value.
- Bad use → maxes out a credit card for clothes, shoes, or a trip → stuck paying for it months or years later.

The Danger Zone

Don't fall for "free money" thinking. Credit isn't free — it's borrowed money you must pay back, often with interest. If you use it wrong, you're making someone else rich while staying broke.

The Babylon Rule Applied to Credit

In The Richest Man in Babylon, debt is called "a man's master." You should never owe for something that doesn't earn for you. Use credit to make more money, not to look like you have money.

Action Step: Build Your Credit Like a Boss

1. Check your score for free on sites like Credit Karma.
2. Make a plan to either start building or repair your credit.
3. Use it for one small recurring bill, pay it off in full every month, and never max out your cards.

Remember: Credit isn't about buying what you can't afford. It's about opening doors to wealth you couldn't reach with cash alone.

Chapter 9 – Keep What You Earn

“It’s not what you make — it’s what you keep that makes you rich.”

Making money is step one.

Keeping it is step two.

Most people never master step two.

If you don’t protect your money, it will slip away through scams, bad deals, impulse buys, and emergencies you weren’t ready for.

The 3 Wealth Killers

1. Scams – If it sounds too good to be true, it’s probably a trap.
 - “Guaranteed” investments with crazy returns.
 - Strangers asking for money or personal info.
 - Fake job offers that require you to “pay first.”
2. Lifestyle Creep – Every time you make more, you spend more. New job? New car. Raise? Bigger apartment. Soon, you’re still broke — just in fancier clothes.
3. Emergency Drain – Medical bills, car repairs, broken appliances — they hit hard if you’re not prepared.

Your Money Armor

- **Emergency Fund** – Save at least \$500 to start, then work toward 3–6 months of expenses. This keeps you from going into debt when life happens.

- **Insurance** – Health, car, renters, or life insurance can keep one bad event from wiping out your money.

- **Separate Accounts** – Keep savings and investments in accounts you don't touch for daily spending.

The Rich Dad Rule: Protect Assets First

Robert Kiyosaki says rich people insure and protect their assets before they buy luxuries. If your money is growing, guard it — don't risk it all for quick gains or unproven ideas.

Avoid the “Fast Money” Trap

Myron Golden warns that “quick money leaves quicker.”

- Fast money often comes with high risk, shady dealings, or no long-term plan.

- If it's not legal, ethical, and scalable, it's not worth it.

The Babylon lesson: “Better a little safe gold than much lost gold.”
Play the long game.

Action Step: Build Your Money Safety Net

1. Open a separate savings account and set an auto-transfer of even \$5/week.

2. Make a list of every insurance you need but don't have yet.

3. Commit to saying “no” to any deal you don't fully understand.

Remember: Wealth isn't just about making money — it's about keeping it safe so it can grow.

10

Chapter 10 – Scaling Up

“Small hustles feed you. Big hustles free you.”

Once you’ve learned how to make money and keep it, the next step is scaling — growing that money machine so it runs bigger, faster, and more efficiently.

Scaling is what takes you from working all the time just to get by... to having income that comes in whether you’re working or not.

Step 1 – Focus on What Works

When you find a hustle that makes consistent money, don’t get distracted by shiny new ideas. Double down.

- If flipping sneakers works, flip more sneakers.
- If your cleaning service is bringing in clients, get more customers before you start a new side hustle.

Wealth grows faster when you pour energy into one thing until it runs smoothly.

Step 2 – System Over Sweat

At first, you work in the hustle. To scale, you need to work on the hustle.

That means:

- Creating repeatable processes (checklists, schedules, tem-

plates).

- Hiring or partnering with others to do the day-to-day work.
- Using tools and technology to save time.

Example: Instead of you delivering every order, hire someone or use a delivery service. You spend your time finding new customers instead.

Step 3 – Leverage Other People's Skills & Money

Rich Dad's lesson: Wealthy people don't do everything themselves. They use:

- Other People's Time (OPT) – Hire, outsource, or partner.
- Other People's Money (OPM) – Loans, investors, or crowd-funding to grow faster.

If you can turn \$1 into \$2 consistently, borrowing \$1,000 to make \$2,000 becomes a smart move.

Step 4 – Keep Reinvesting

When your income grows, resist the urge to upgrade your lifestyle right away. Reinvest profits into:

- Marketing to get more customers.
- Better equipment or tools.
- Expanding your product or service line.

This is how you turn a \$100-a-week hustle into a \$1,000-a-week business.

The Myron Golden Principle

Myron says, "Your income is a reflection of the problems you solve."

If you want to scale, solve bigger problems for more people — and charge accordingly.

Action Step: Create Your Scale Plan

1. Pick your most profitable hustle.
2. Write down every task you do for it.
3. Circle the ones you can automate, outsource, or delegate.

4. Set a 90-day goal for doubling your monthly profit.

Remember: Scaling isn't about working harder — it's about building a machine that works harder than you do.

11

Chapter 11 – Breaking the Generational Curse

“You might be the first... but you don’t have to be the last.”

For a lot of at-risk and disadvantaged youth, money struggles aren’t just bad luck — they’re inherited.

Not because someone passed down debt like they passed down a family photo, but because the same cycle kept repeating:

- No money → no knowledge → bad decisions → no wealth to pass on → next generation starts at zero.

You can stop that cycle.

Step 1 – Change the Money Mindset in Your Circle

You can’t build wealth in a broke mindset environment. If your friends or family believe:

- “We’ll always be broke”
- “Rich people are lucky or crooked”
- “Money doesn’t matter”

...then part of your mission is to live differently so they see a new possibility.

Step 2 – Pass Down Knowledge Before You Pass Down Money

If you give someone \$10,000 with no financial literacy, they'll lose it.

If you teach someone how to make, keep, and grow \$10,000, they'll never be broke again.

From Richest Man in Babylon: Teach others “the laws of gold” — save first, invest wisely, avoid debt.

Step 3 – Build Assets That Outlive You

- Property – Homes, land, rentals.
- Businesses – Something that keeps making money even when you're gone.
- Investments – Stocks, funds, or other income-generating assets.

These are things you can pass on to kids, nieces, nephews — so they start where you finish, not where you started.

Step 4 – Create Traditions Around Money

Just like your family might have traditions for holidays, create traditions for:

- Family money meetings.
- Annual investment check-ins.
- Celebrating debt payoffs or business wins.

When financial literacy becomes normal in your home, wealth becomes normal in your family.

Step 5 – Give Back Without Going Broke

Helping your community is powerful — but help smart.

- Instead of giving handouts, give opportunities.
- Mentor younger kids on money and entrepreneurship.
- Start small programs or events that teach skills, not just give things away.

Action Step: Start Your Legacy Plan

1. Write down at least one financial lesson you want the next generation to know.

2. Choose one asset you will build or buy this year that could be passed down.

3. Commit to having one money conversation a month with someone younger than you.

Remember: The greatest wealth you can give your family is not just money — it's the mindset and tools to multiply it.

12

Chapter 12 – The Wealth Playbook

“Knowledge is power... but only if you use it.”

You’ve now got the mindset, the money rules, and the skills. But knowing and doing are two different things.

This chapter is your action map — follow it, and your financial life will change.

Phase 1 – Stabilize Your Finances (First 30–60 Days)

Goal: Get control over your money and stop the leaks.

1. Track every dollar you spend for 30 days.
2. Cut or reduce unnecessary expenses (subscriptions, takeout, impulse buys).
3. Open a separate savings account and save at least \$10 a week.
4. Build a \$500 emergency fund as fast as possible.

Phase 2 – Build Your Money Muscle (Months 2–6)

Goal: Learn to earn, keep, and grow money.

1. Choose one hustle from Chapters 6–7 that fits your skills.
2. Set a target income goal from the hustle (e.g., \$200/month).

3. Save at least 10% of every dollar you earn.

4. Use the 50-30-20 Rule:

- 50% needs (rent, food, bills)
- 30% wants (fun, extras)
- 20% savings/investing

Phase 3 – Multiply Your Income (Months 6–12)

Goal: Turn your hustle into a money machine.

1. Track which customers, products, or services bring the most money.

2. Double down on what's working.

3. Automate or outsource smaller tasks so you can focus on growth.

4. Reinvest profits into marketing, better tools, or more inventory.

Phase 4 – Build Long-Term Wealth (Year 1–3)

Goal: Turn cash flow into assets that grow over time.

1. Open an investment account (start small — even \$25/month).

2. Learn about index funds, real estate, or other long-term investments.

3. Avoid bad debt; pay off high-interest loans as fast as possible.

4. Create or buy an asset that can be passed down (property, business, or investments).

Phase 5 – Legacy & Generational Wealth (Year 3 and beyond)

Goal: Make sure your progress outlives you.

1. Teach at least one other person everything you've learned.

2. Put your assets in a will or trust.

3. Keep building income streams so future generations start ahead.

4. Give back to your community with opportunities, not just

donations.

Daily Wealth Habits

- Read 10–20 minutes from books on money and success.
- Track spending and income daily.
- Review goals weekly.
- Avoid unnecessary debt.
- Always save first, spend second.

Final Word

The path from at-risk youth to financially free adult is not instant — but it is possible. Thousands have done it starting with less than you have now. The key is start now, stay consistent, and never stop learning.

